

Inha University in Tashkent

***Theme 9: Social Protection of the Population and Strengthening of
Inter-Ethnic Harmony***

Tashkent – 2024

Outline:

Strong Social Protection of
Population is the Main State Policy

State Actions towards Social
Protection of Population

The Activity of National Cultural
Centers in Uzbekistan

Strong Social Protection of Population is the Main State Policy

- After the proclamation of Independence of Uzbekistan, ensuring the social protection of the population has become main state policy in the process of transition to market economy. As well as the fact that a significant part of the world's recognized five principles, developed by the First President Islam Karimov, is a strong social protection of the population.
- The initial stage of transition to market economy was closely related to such issues as:
 - denationalization;
 - price liberalization;
 - reduction of wages;
 - the emergence of an insecure population.
- Therefore, special attention was paid to the protection of the level of income of the population in Uzbekistan.





The Aims of Actions and Reforms

- The real purpose of all reforms that has implemented in the country is to create decent living conditions for the citizens.
- Moreover, the ignorance of people's social problems is a threat to stability and national security.
- During the first difficult years of independence, in the years of hard economic conditions, many methods and reforms of governance were used in order to normalize people's lives.
- First, measures have been taken to preserve the level of income of the population in conditions of changes in the prices of consumer goods and sharp decline in money (inflation).



Protection of Level of Income



- A unified tariff scale was introduced in January 1993.
- This measure has allowed directly linking employees' salaries through tariff rates, to the minimum wage. By raising the minimum wage, the average wage and money incomes have also increased.
- Until 2009, wages were paid according to 23 (0-22) categories.
- On July 21, 2009, the Cabinet Ministers of Uzbekistan issued decree on "The Further Improvement of the Unified Tariff Scale of Labor Payment".
- Categories of labor payment decreased in 22 (1-22).

Tariff discharges	Tariff coefficients	Tariff rates from 01.04.2002 (soms)
0	1,000	3945
1	2,014	7945
2	2,216	8742
3	2,439	9622
4	2,681	10577
5	2,937	11586
6	3,205	12644
7	3,484	13744
8	3,773	14884
9	4,064	16032
10	4,361	17204
11	4,663	18396
12	4,973	19618
13	5,288	20861
14	5,606	22116
15	5,931	23398
16	6,259	24692
17	6,593	26009
18	6,930	27339
19	7,273	28692
20	7,620	30061
21	7,973	31453
22	8,328	32854



State's Regulated Prices

- The living standards of the population depend on:
 - the domestic consumer market
 - the prices for food
 - the prices for household goods.
- In the process of liberalization of the prices implemented at the first stage of economic reforms, measures were taken to protect the social protection of the population, state control of the domestic consumer market.
- The prices have been gradually liberalized since January 1992, with preliminarily planned measures for social protection of the population.
- In accordance with the Decree of the Cabinet of Ministers "On Measures for Price Liberalization" from January 10, 1992, a wide range of industrial goods, technical means in Uzbekistan have been approved by the fixed (free) prices and tariffs.
- The government has set the boundaries of prices for food and industrial goods in limited quantities for the protection of the population and the highest tariffs for certain types of services.



The Reforms on Liberalization of Prices

- In 1993, the list of goods and services sold at fixed and regulated prices was significantly reduced. State regulation of import wholesale prices was suspended.
- In October-November 1994, prices for basic types of consumer goods were issued, tariffs for transport and utilities services were raised.
- However, for the purpose of social protection of the population bread, flour prices, housing, communal services and urban transport continued in fixed manner.
- At the same time, additional social benefits have been introduced. For example, free breakfast for primary school students and single pensioners, free meals for children under 2 years old, discount for food for schoolteachers and students.

Actions on Social Protection

- Following actions on social protection were introduced:
 - * Payment of 1.5 times minimum wage to families with children under 2 years of age;
 - * Providing women with an average monthly salary of 125 calendar days during pregnancy and childbirth;
 - * Allowance for disabled people from childhood;
 - * 50% of privileged payment for communal services and apartment usage (for the family of disabled person);
 - * Exemption from payment for communal services and apartment usage to residents living in rural areas and 50% of privileged payment for communal services and apartment usage in cities (school teachers, tutors and teachers, academic staff, teachers of higher and secondary special education);
 - * 50% discount for electricity consumption (disabled family);
 - * Exemption from land tax (families with 5 or more children under the age of 16, families of invalids).

Government support for the elderly and the disabled



- In recent years, special attention is being paid to issues of public health, protection of motherhood and childhood, reliable access to drugs, upbringing of physically and spiritually healthy generation.
- In particular, a limited price of 340 titles of medicines and medical supplies was installed.
- A mechanism for government support for the elderly and the disabled has been developed. According to the decree of the Cabinet of Ministers that adopted on March 9, residents and guests of the capital have the right to use the subway service from 10.00 to 16.00, with indication of a pension certificate from March 15, 2017.

Inter-ethnic factors



- The role of inter-ethnic factors in ensuring the socio-political stability in the country is crucial.
- In ancient times, representatives of different cultures and civilizations in our country, interfering with different nations and ethnic groups, lived in friendship and solidarity.
- Russia, then the former Soviet Union's migration policy has resulted in a more diverse population of polyethnic structures.

Legal bases for interethnic harmony

- Legal bases for interethnic harmony have been created during the years of Independence.
- According to the articles of Constitution of Uzbekistan: 'All citizens of the Republic of Uzbekistan, regardless of their nationality, shall constitute the people of Uzbekistan (article 8).
- All citizens of the Republic of Uzbekistan shall have equal rights and freedoms, and shall be equal before law without discrimination by sex, race, nationality, language, religion, social origin, convictions, individual and social status. Any privileges may be granted solely by law and must conform to the principles of social justice (article 19).'

Ethnic groups and Religious confessions

- Languages, traditions and customs of all nations and nationalities living in Uzbekistan are respected, and conditions for their development are created.
- Thanks to the national policy, there was a process of integration of ethno-cultural foundations among representatives of all ethnic groups living in Uzbekistan.
- Today, it is rightly admirable that in Uzbekistan, more than 130 ethnic groups and 16 religious confessions live in peace and harmony, working together for the sake of the development of our country and the welfare of our people.



- Following the independence of our homeland, on January 13, 1992, the International Republican Cultural Center firstly was established in Uzbekistan among Central Asian republics.
- In Uzbekistan, in 1992, there were 10 national cultural centers of different nationalities and ethnicities in Uzbekistan, and today their number has reached 137.
- The main focus was on the integration of nations and peoples.
- In 2016, It were held and organized more than 700 scientific-practical and cultural events.
- More than 40,000 people from different nationalities have been active in the sixth annual festival of friendship and culture "Uzbekistan - our common home".



The activity of National Cultural Centers

- National Cultural Centers operate in three main areas:
 - ✓ restoration of language, culture, customs and traditions of every nation, development of relations with the historical Motherland;
 - ✓ recognizing Uzbekistan as their true Motherland and serving it loyally;
 - ✓ to live in friendship, co-operation and harmony with the Uzbek people, to know its language, culture and history.
- At present, educational programs are being implemented in seven languages in the country's educational institutions. There are programs and broadcasts, as well as, newspapers and magazines are being published in more than 10 languages.
- Representatives of all nationalities living in Uzbekistan are actively involved in national holidays - Independence Day, Navruz. At these holidays, art lovers from Russia, Ukraine, Azerbaijan, Kazakhstan, Tatar and other nations are welcomed with enthusiasm and joy.



Thank you for your attention!